

Practice Quiz: Perception — Counting Stitches, Noticing Drift

Part A: Multiple Choice

1. Stitch counting at the end of a row is best described as: A) A tedious chore with no deeper purpose B) State estimation — using a discrete observation to check the pattern's prediction C) A way to slow down your work D) Something only beginners need to do
2. When you notice your fabric "looks off" but cannot immediately identify why, you are experiencing: A) A random feeling with no informational content B) Prediction error detected below conscious awareness by your generative model C) A desire to start a different project D) Boredom with the current pattern
3. Gauge checking functions in Active Inference as: A) An unnecessary tradition B) Model validation — testing whether the pattern's prior predictions match your observed measurements C) A way to waste yarn on swatches D) Proof that you followed instructions correctly
4. A high-precision perceptual signal in crochet would be: A) A vague sense that the project is going well B) An exact stitch count on a simple single-crochet row C) The general appearance of the fabric from across the room D) A feeling that you like the color
5. Stitch markers help with perception by: A) Making the project prettier B) Increasing the precision of your state estimation by creating reference points C) Replacing the need to follow a pattern D) Indicating when to stop for the day
6. "Tension drift" — a gradual change in gauge as you work — is difficult to detect because: A) It produces no visible effects B) The change is so gradual that no single row triggers a prediction error C) It only happens to beginners D) Tension never actually changes during a project

7. When a pattern includes a stitch count, it is implicitly directing your: A) Color choice B) Attention — telling you to deploy high-precision observation at this point C) Hook size D) Yarn brand preference

Part B: Short Answer

1. Describe two situations where you would rely on high-precision perception (deliberate counting/measuring) and two where you would rely on low-precision perception (gestalt impression). What determines which mode you use?
2. A crocheter finishes a sweater panel and discovers it is 2 inches shorter than specified. Analyze this situation in terms of perception: what observations were missed, what predictions went unchecked, and how could earlier perceptual monitoring have caught the problem?
3. Explain how an experienced crocheter's perceptual system differs from a beginner's. Use the concept of precision-weighted sensory channels to describe at least two specific differences.